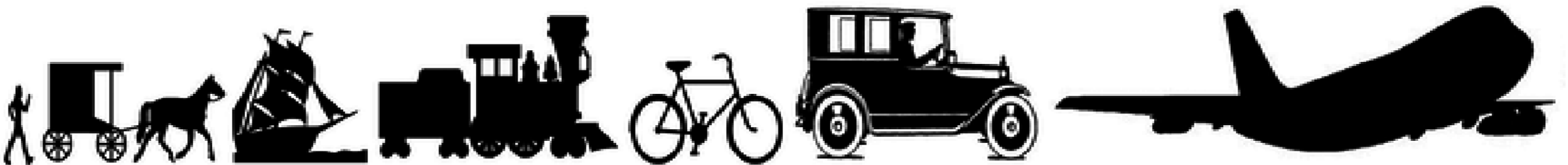


HISTORY OF MASS MEDIA IN AFRICA



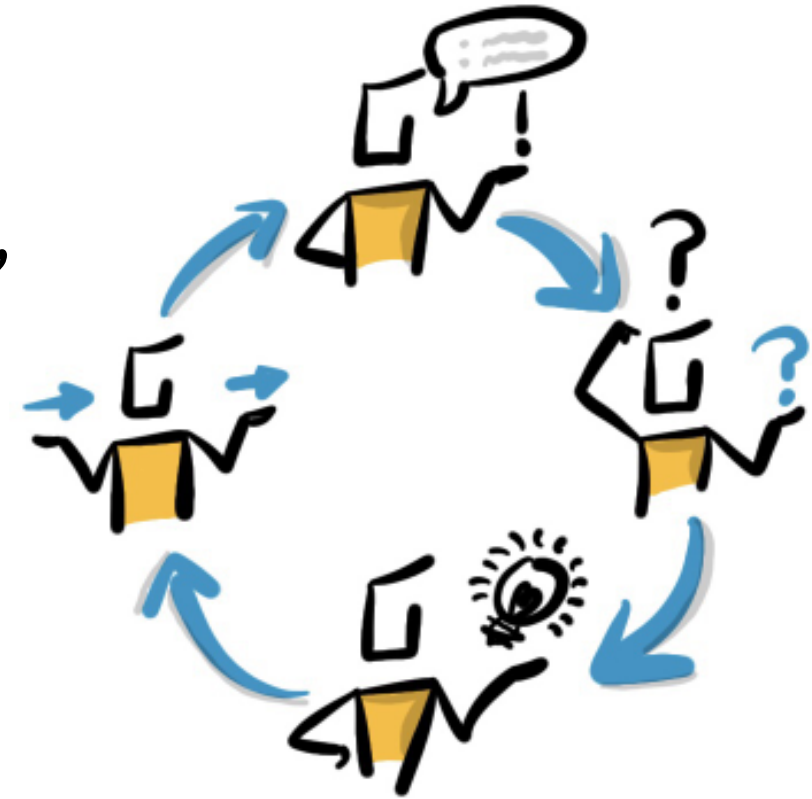
Course overview

- The **present** state of the human society is **not what has always been**.
- When you closely **examine any activity** or phenomenon of life, from cooking, transportation, education, communication, etc., you would realize that **its current practice is different from how it was years back**.
- There is always **the need to understand** what **existed before** the present.
- Why is that so?



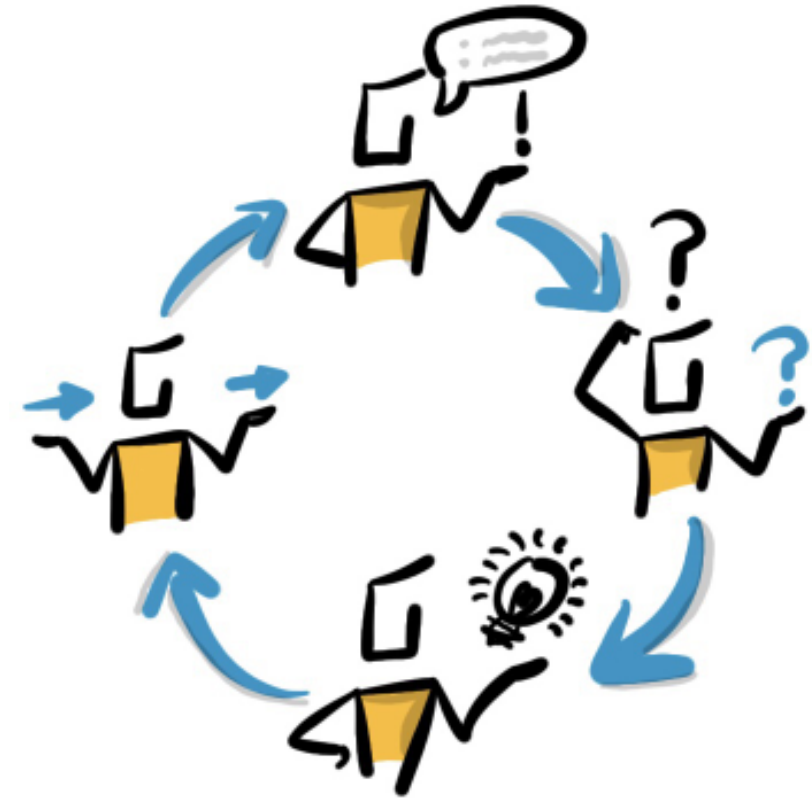
Course overview: Course details

- This course is designed to develop the communication potential of students by looking at the origin and the transformation of the media in Sub-Saharan Africa before, during, and after colonialism.
- It identifies the oral discourse, creativity, humanity, and agency of the traditional features of information dissemination.



Course overview: Course details

- It will also identify the role of the media, especially print and broadcast journalism in the struggle for independence in Africa and the various stages of development the industry has seen over the years.
- The mode of delivery will be through lectures, discussions, group presentations and group work.



Course overview: Course learning objectives

At the end of the course, students will be able to:

1. Discuss the evolution of journalism from the pre-colonial era to the present day.
2. Discuss how the colonialists influenced the development of media culture and freedom of the press in the various territories.
3. Explain the contributions made by media men towards the attainment of political freedom in Africa.



Course overview: Course learning outcomes

At the end of the course, students will be able to:

1. Demonstrate an in-depth understanding of the history and structure of the media in Sub-Saharan Africa.
2. Describe the roles played by politicians, journalists, and publishers in the independence struggle.
3. Discuss the influence of European cultures on the media in Africa



Course overview: Weekly topics



WEEK	TOPIC
Week 1	The fundamentals of communication
Week 2	The Media In Pre-colonial Africa
Week 3	The Emergence of Newspaper in Colonial Africa
Week 4	Newspaper in Post-colonial Africa
Week 5	Group presentation
Week 6	5. Radio at and After Independence in Africa

Course overview: Weekly topics

WEEK	TOPIC
Week 7	Mid-semester examination
Week 8	Building of Media Infrastructure and Human Resource
Week 9	The Advent of Television in Africa (Ghana as a case study)
Week 10	The Media in Post Independent Africa.
Week 11	Revision
Week 12	Examination week

Course overview: Interim assessments & Mode of delivery

	ACTIVITY DESCRIPTION	SCORES (%)
1.	Class Participation	5%
2.	Class Attendance	5%
3.	Group Readings/Presentations	10%
4.	Mid-semester Examination	20%
2.	End-of-semester Examination	60%

MODE OF DELIVERY

- Lectures
- Group readings
- Class presentations

Rules of engagement in class

1. No **absenteeism** will be entertained. Seek **appropriate permission** only when very necessary.
2. No **lateness**. Students should be **seated before** the scheduled lecture period.
3. All mobile **phones** should be **silenced or switched off**.
4. **Respect the opinions** of **other** students.
5. **Submit all assignments on time**.
6. **Participate in group assignments/projects**.
7. Do well to **contribute** (ask questions or make submissions) and **behave properly** in class.

RULES OF
ENGAGEMENT

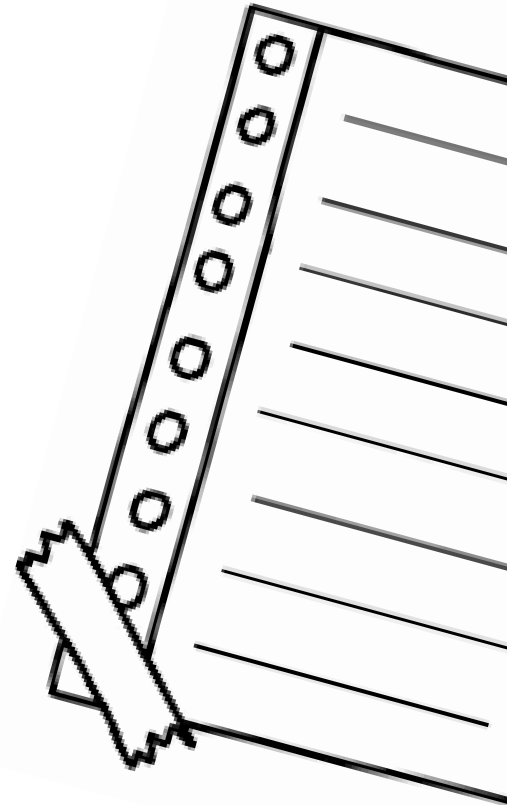
History of Mass Media in Africa

Lecture one: The Fundamentals of Communication

The fundamentals of communication

OUTLINE

- I. Introduction to the topic
- II. The communication process
- III. Types and forms of communication
- IV. Contexts of communication
- V. Barriers to effective communication
- VI. Ethics of communication



The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Objectives of the Lecture

By the end of the lecture, learners should be able to:

1. understand communication fundamentals
2. explore different communication types and models
3. discuss barriers to effective communication and strategies to overcome them
4. understand ethical communication and how to make navigate ethical dilemmas.

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

What is communication?

Depending on the perspective, communication can be seen as a technical process, a meaning–sharing activity, or a social interaction.

Generally, however, communication is a multidimensional process involving the transmission, interpretation, and exchange of messages between individuals or groups.

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Importance of communication in our daily lives

1. Communication addresses our physical needs. As social beings, our physical and mental health depends largely on the opportunity and ability to interact.

We can barely survive without human contact, as a 13th-century study by Frederick II, emperor of Germany, showed.

Human interaction—especially touch—is critical for infants' survival and healthy development as shown by more recent studies in orphanages and adoption centers.

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Importance of communication in our daily lives

1. **Communication addresses our physical needs.** Positive social interaction keeps adult healthy, too, as research shows that people without close friendships and family relationships are more likely to suffer from major ailments like heart disease and high blood pressure and basic ones like cold, often take longer to recover from illnesses and injuries, and die more prematurely than people who have close, satisfying relationships.

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Importance of communication in our daily lives

2. Communication meets our relational needs. Relational needs are the essential needs we look for in our relationships with other people, like companionship and affection, relaxation, and escape.

We need relationships in our lives to satisfy these needs, and communication is a large part of how we establish and maintain those relationships.

Can you imagine how challenging it would be to form and maintain strong social relationships if you did not have the ability to communicate with others?

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Importance of communication in our daily lives

2. Communication meets our relational needs. Some scholars believe that our need for relationships is so fundamental that we can hardly get by without them. For instance, research has shown that having a rich social life is one of the most powerful predictors of a person's overall happiness in life.

Marital happiness is the single most important predictor of a happy life. It is more important than income, job status, education, leisure time, or anything else in accounting for how happy people are in their lives.

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Importance of communication in our daily lives

2. Communication meets our relational needs. On the negative side, people in distressed marriages are much more likely to suffer from major depression, and they even report being in worse physical health than their happily married counterparts.

It is evident from the above that personal relationships play an important role in our lives, and communication helps us form and maintain them.

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Importance of communication in our daily lives

3. Communication fills our identity needs. Are you intelligent? Are you shy? Are you attractive?

Each of us can come up with a long list adjectives to describe ourselves, but the critical question is: *How do you know you are these things?* In other words, how do you form an identity?

Our communications with others play a major role in shaping the way we see ourselves. We form identities partly by comparing ourselves with others.

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Importance of communication in our daily lives

3. Communication fills our identity needs. If you consider yourself intelligent, what that really means is that you see yourself as more intelligent than most other people. If you think you are shy, you see most other people as more outgoing than you are.

One way we learn how we compare to others is through our communication with those around us. If people treat you as intelligent, shy, or attractive, you will probably begin to believe that you have those characteristics. In other words, those qualities will become part of your self image.

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Importance of communication in our daily lives

3. Communication fills our identity needs. Good communicators also know how to emphasize different aspects of their identities in different situations. For example, during a job interview, it might be important for you to portray your organized, efficient side, whereas, on a date, you might choose to project your fun-loving nature and sense of humour.

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Importance of communication in our daily lives

4. Communication meets our spiritual needs. An important aspect of identity for many people is their spirituality, as a 2015 survey of more than 112,000 US college students found, including values (“I value loyalty”), morals (“It’s never okay to steal”), and beliefs (I trust in God).

For those who include spirituality as a part of their identity, communication provides a means of expressing and sharing their spiritual ideas and practices with one another.

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Importance of communication in our daily lives

5. Communication serves our instrumental needs. We also communicate to meet our practical everyday needs, what researchers refer to as *instrumental needs*, such as raising your hands to talk in class, ordering food at the cafeteria, getting a job, and earning a promotion.

The communicative behaviours entailed in serving these instrumental needs may not always contribute directly to our health, relationships, identity, or spirituality but is as valuable because it serves a need that helps us get through daily life.

The fundamentals of communication

I. Introduction

Importance of communication in our daily lives

5. Communication serves our instrumental needs. Again, meeting instrumental needs may not be as interesting as forging new relationships or as meaningful as expressing spiritual beliefs, but it is important for two reasons: 1. that we have many instrumental needs and 2. that they must be met before other needs.

For example, buying food at the store ought to be met before maintaining quality relationships or finding career fulfillment.

The fundamentals of communication

II. The Communication Process

Key Elements of Communication

1. Sender: the individual or organization transmitting the message
2. Message: the content being transmitted (PR campaigns, ads, news)
3. Channel: the pathway for conveying the message (newspapers, TV)
4. Receiver: the individual or group interpreting the message
5. Noise: anything that interferes with the transmission process (physical, psychological, physiological)
6. Feedback: the response provided by the receiver

The fundamentals of communication

II. The Communication Process

Models of Communication

How would you describe the process of communicating?

Describing the communication process is not as easy as it might seem. Researchers have answered that question in different ways.

A formal description of a process such as communication is called a model.

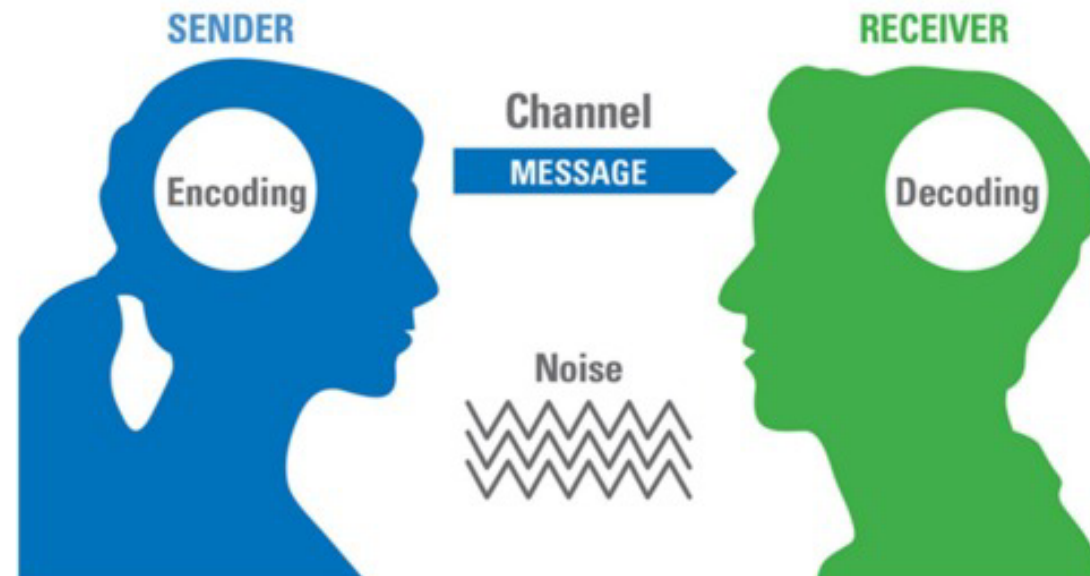
Let us explore three different models that communication scholars have developed: the action model, the interaction model, and the transaction model of communication.

The fundamentals of communication

II. The Communication Process

Models of Communication

The Action Model: Here, communication is thought of as a one-way process, hence The Linear Model. The one-way can be top-down or bottom-up.



The fundamentals of communication

II. The Communication Process

Models of Communication

The Action Model. You can see that the action model is linear. However, human communication is rarely that simple. In fact, it is usually more back-and-forth exchange than a one-way process—more like tennis than bowling.

Thus, over time, researchers responded to this observation by creating an updated model of communication known as *the interaction model*.

The fundamentals of communication

II. The Communication Process

B. Models of communication

The Interaction Model: This model takes up where the action model leaves off.

It includes all the elements of the action model—sender, encoding, message, channel, receiver, decoding, and noise—but differs from it in two basic ways: 1. communication is a two-way process, and 2. it adds two elements to the mix—feedback and context.

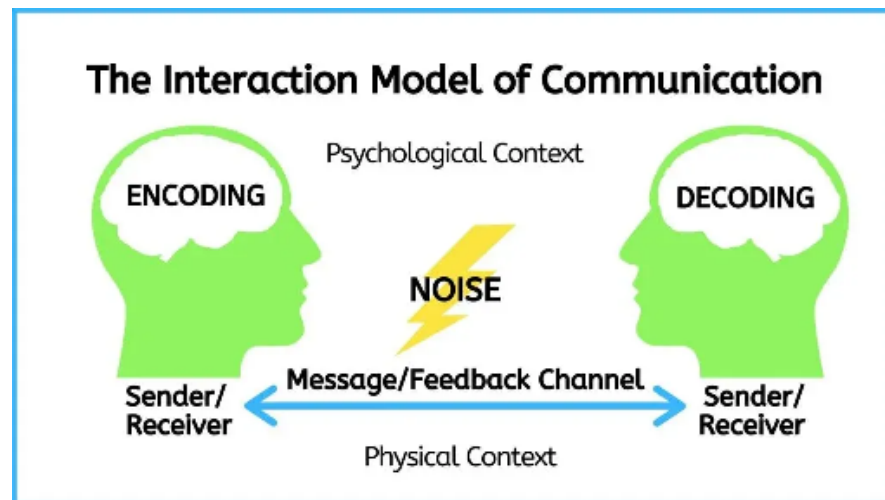
Feedback

The fundamentals of communication

II. The Communication Process

Models of Communication

The Interaction Model: Context can be physical (the physical environment) or psychological (factors that influence the state of mind, such as the formality of the situation, level of privacy, degree to which the situation is emotionally charged).



The fundamentals of communication

II. The Communication Process

Models of communication

The Interaction Model: By taking account of feedback and context, the interaction presents the communication process more realistically than the action model.

However, the interaction model has its own limitations. One drawback is that it does not represent how complex communication can be.

During conversations, it often seems as though both parties are sending and receiving information simultaneously, rather than simply communicating back and forth, one message at a time.

The fundamentals of communication

II. The Communication Process

Models of Communication

The Interaction Model: The interaction model, however, does not account that overlapping two-way process.

To understand that aspect of communication, we turn to *the transaction model*.

The fundamentals of communication

II. The Communication Process

Models of Communication

The Transaction Model: Unlike the action and interaction models, the transaction model of communication does not distinguish between the roles of sender and receiver. Nor does it represent communication as a series of messages going back and forth.

Rather, it maintains that both parties in a conversation are simultaneously senders and receivers.

Also, it illustrates that the conversation flows in both directions at the same time, hence *multidimensional or dialogic communication model*.

The fundamentals of communication

II. The Communication Process

Models of Communication

The Transaction Model: The transaction model takes the interaction model a little higher.

For instance, it recognizes that the sender will interpret the feedback as a message in and of itself, making him or her a receiver too, at the same time.

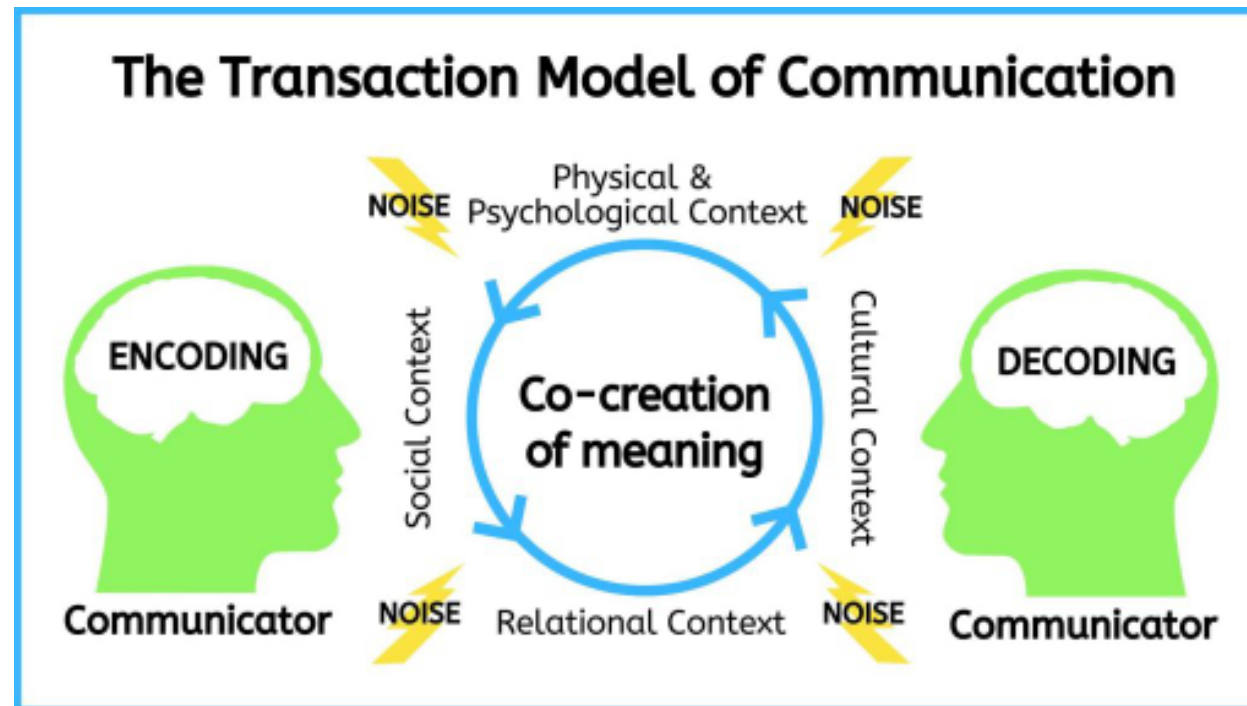
In terms of context, the transaction model suggests that our communication is affected not just by the physical or psychological environment but also by our experience, gender, social class, culture, and even history of our relationship with the other communicative partner.

The fundamentals of communication

II. The Communication Process

Models of communication

The Transaction Model



The fundamentals of communication

III. Types and Forms of Communication

Verbal Communication

Oral communication: face-to-face conversations, speeches, interviews, radio and TV talk shows, etc.

Written communication: press releases, articles, e-mail communication, books, newspapers, digital text

Non-verbal communication

Body language: gestures, facial expressions, posture, eye contact, etc.

Symbol: brand images, logos

The fundamentals of communication

III. Types and Forms of Communication

Visual Communication

Cartoons: used in political and social commentary to communicate messages humously

Infographics: such as images, charts, and graphs simplify complex information for easy understanding

Digital Communication

Social media: such as Facebook, Twitter, and Instagram used for PR campaigns

New media: such as blogs, podcasts, and online forums used as alternative communication tools

The fundamentals of communication

IV. Contexts of Communication

Communication occurs in five basic contexts: intrapersonal, interpersonal, small group, public, and mass.

These five communication contexts differ mainly with respect to the size of the audience, but they also call for different communication skills.

The fundamentals of communication

IV. Contexts of Communication

Intrapersonal Communication: Includes the smallest audience. This is a type of communication we have with ourselves. For example, reminding yourself to do something or rehearsing an upcoming conversation in your mind.

It may be tempting to equate intrapersonal communication with thinking. However, your thoughts and memories become communicative when you put them into words.

The fundamentals of communication

IV. Contexts of Communication

Interpersonal Communication: An exchange of instant messages with another person. It occurs between two people in the context of the ongoing relationship.

For example, talking on the phone with a relative and talking face-to-face with a supervisor.

Research shows this is the most common form of communication we enact. Even in larger social groups, such as families and organisations, much of our communication is typically interpersonal in nature.

The fundamentals of communication

III. Contexts of Communication

Small Group Communication: Sometimes, we all interact in small groups of people, such as teams of students working on a class project, sports teams, Bible study groups, and organizational departments.

When we communicate with groups of between 3 and 20 people, we are engaging in small-group communication. These groups have specific ways of making decisions, negotiating power, and working together in the service of common goals.

The fundamentals of communication

III. Contexts of Communication

Public Communication: This occurs when we speak or write to an audience that is larger than a small group.

An example is when you give a welcome speech at a retreat for your organization.

Because your communication targets a larger audience, you might spend more time preparing and practicing your remarks than if you were talking to a friend or a small group.

The fundamentals of communication

III. Contexts of Communication

Mass communication: Public communication—i.e., communication delivered to a large audience—becomes mass communication if it is transmitted via electronic or print media, such as magazines, television, radio, blogs, and websites.

Because its audience is so large, mass communication works well for distributing not only news, commentary, and entertainment but also PR campaigns and advertisements.

This makes the mass media an indispensable tool in public relations practice. That is, by virtue of what they do with media, public relations practitioners and managers are also media people.

The fundamentals of communication

III. Contexts of Communication

Mass communication: Therefore, as PR students, studying the origin and evolution of the media will help you gain a deeper appreciation of media dynamics, audience behaviour, and communication technologies.

This knowledge will enhance your ability to craft effective messages, manage media relations, and build strategic campaigns that resonate with African audiences.

Ultimately, you will tend to practice and manage PR in ways that are both effective and efficient.

The fundamentals of communication

V. Barriers to Effective Communication

At each stage of the communication process—encoding, transferring, and decoding—there is the possibility of interference that may hinder the process. Such interference is known as *noise*.

Often, a comparison is made between communication and a leaky bucket. If you carry water in a leaky bucket, you will lose water at various points in your journey, from the water tap to your destination.

The amount of water you lose depends on the number of holes in the bucket, the size of the holes, and the distance to your destination.

The fundamentals of communication

V. Barriers to Effective Communication

Similarly, when information is transferred from a sender to a receiver, all information may not be received by the receiver because of holes called *noise*.

Each noise may not affect the amount of information transferred. Just as in the leaky bucket more holes decrease the amount of water, more noise decreases the amount of correct information received.

Communication barriers can be classified under:

The fundamentals of communication

V. Barriers to Effective Communication

Physical barriers: The environment in which the sender and receiver are present should be compatible. A noisy environment may hinder the hearing and understanding of the message . Background noise often created by colleagues, vehicles, and machinery may hinder proper communication.

Noise

Distance

Technical issues

The fundamentals of communication

V. Barriers to Effective Communication

Psychological barriers such as prejudices, stress, and emotions can also interrupt the communication process.

The fundamentals of communication

V. Barriers to Effective Communication

Language barriers: The receiver may not completely understand the different language used by the sender.

There may also be a language problem in the communication process if the message contains technical information and the receiver is not familiar with the technical terms used.

Poorly chosen words, careless omissions, lack of coherence, poor organization of ideas, awkward sentence structure, inadequate vocabulary, unnecessary jargon, accent, pronunciation, and the failure to clarify implications are some of the common reasons for the poor transmission of messages.

The fundamentals of communication

V. Barriers to Effective Communication

Cultural barriers: Cultural differences created by an individual's background and experience, affect their perception of the world. Such cultural differences may affect the interpretation (decoding) of the messages sent.

The fundamentals of communication

V. Barriers to Effective Communication

Strategies to Overcome Barriers:

- Active listening

- Clear and simple messaging

- Cross-cultural understanding

Guide learners to come up with more strategies based on their understanding of the barriers, which they like face in their everyday lives.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Key Principles of Ethical Communication

Honesty

Integrity

Respect for others

Objectivity

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Importance of Ethical Communication

As communication continues to evolve in the digital age, ethical considerations remain critical for fostering informed, respectful, and responsible discourse. Ethical communication is fundamental in public relations for various reasons.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Importance of Ethical Communication

- 1. It builds credibility and trust:** Ethical communication fosters trust between individuals, organizations, and the public. Ethical communication involves honesty, accuracy, and fairness, which are critical for credibility. Credibility, over time, leads to trust, which the success of public relations rests on. However, misleading or deceptive communication erodes trust and can lead to reputational damage.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Importance of Ethical Communication

2. **Ethical communication acknowledges cultural differences and promotes inclusivity.** Communication is deeply rooted in cultural contexts, and ethical communicators must be aware of their biases, stereotypes, and power dynamics that can affect interpretations and avoid them.
3. **Ethical communication fosters professional integrity and accountability.** Professional codes of ethics, such as those from the Institute of Public Relations Ghana, stress accountability and transparency in communication. Ethical communication requires decision-making guided by integrity rather than personal or organizational gain.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Importance of Ethical Communication

4. **It promotes social responsibility.** Ethical communication ensures that messages contribute positively to society. Some public relations scholars argue that ethical PR practice should align with corporate social responsibility (CSR), ensuring that communication serves both organizational and societal interests rather than misleading stakeholders.
5. **Ethical communication controls misinformation and manipulation.** The rise of fake news and misinformation has made ethical communication more crucial than ever. Misinformation spreads rapidly in digital spaces, making it imperative for communicators to verify and present information responsibly. Thus, ethical communication practices help prevent the distortion of facts.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Importance of Ethical Communication

6. Unethical communication can lead to legal consequences, including defamation lawsuits, data privacy breaches, and regulatory penalties. Ethical communication frameworks help professionals navigate legal boundaries while maintaining ethical standards.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Ethical Dilemmas in Communication

Ethical dilemmas in communication arise when communicators must choose between competing moral principles, often balancing truth, transparency, and social responsibility.

Scholars in media ethics, public relations, and communication studies have identified key dilemmas as well as strategies to handle them.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Ethical Dilemmas in Communication

Truth vs Loyalty

Dilemma: Communicators may struggle between telling the truth and remaining loyal to their organizations or audience. For instance, a PR officer may need to disclose negative information about their company while also protecting its reputation.

Handling strategy: Bowen (2008) suggests applying the *Kantian duty-based* ethics approach, which advocates prioritising truthfulness regardless of consequences, as transparency fosters trust in the long term.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Ethical Dilemmas in Communication

Privacy vs Public Interest

Dilemma: Journalists and media professionals must decide how much personal information to disclose when reporting on sensitive issues. Exposing private matters might serve the public interest but harm individuals.

Handling strategy: According to Christian et al. (2009), the *Utilitarian* ethical approach of weighing harms against benefits can guide decision-making. Media people should follow guidelines to minimize harm while serving the public good.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Ethical Dilemmas in Communication

Persuasion vs Manipulation

Dilemma: Advertisers, marketers, and political communicators often face the challenge of influencing audiences without deceiving them. Exaggerating claims can mislead consumers

Handling strategy: Heath (2013) argues that ethical persuasion follows the dialogical approach, whereby communication is a two-way process that respects the audience's autonomy and intelligence. Practitioners should avoid misleading information to achieve their goals but provide full disclosure for more informed decision-making.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Ethical Dilemmas in Communication

Conflicts of Interests

Dilemma: PR officers, corporate communicators, and journalists may find themselves in situations in which personal interests conflict with professional responsibilities. For instance, a journalist covering a company in which they have shares may face bias.

Handling strategy: According to Wilkings & Christians (2008), transparency and disclosure are key. Ethical codes, such as those from the *Public Relations Society of America* (PRSA), recommend avoiding situations where personal gains affect objectivity.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Ethical Dilemmas in Communication

Censorship vs Freedom of Expression

Dilemma: Organisations and governments may restrict communication in the name of corporate confidentiality, national security, or cultural sensitivity, sometimes suppressing important information.

Handling strategy: Habermas (1984) emphasizes *communicative rationality*, whereby open dialogue helps balance freedom and responsibility. Communicators should follow legal and ethical standards, advocating responsible discourse while respecting confidentiality when necessary.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Ethical Dilemmas in Communication

Stereotyping and Cultural Sensitivity

Dilemma: Media representations may reinforce stereotypes or offend cultural groups, intentionally or unintentionally, such as an advertising campaign carrying racial or gender biases.

Handling strategy: Hall (1977) stresses the importance of *representation ethics*, urging communicators to be aware of cultural nuances and avoid reinforcing harmful biases. Ethical frameworks, such as UNESCO's *Guidelines for Inclusive Media*, promote diversity and fair representation.

The fundamentals of communication

VI. Ethics of Communication

Ethical Dilemmas in Communication

Ethical Use of Digital and AI Communication

Dilemma: With the rise of AI-generated content, deepfakes, and misinformation, communicators face challenges in ensuring authenticity and responsible use of technology.

Handling strategy: Floridi & Taddeo (2016) advocate *digital ethics*, which include verifying sources, disclosing AI-generated content, and ensuring that digital tools serve ethical communication purposes. PR organizations should implement AI ethics policies and fact-checking mechanisms.

The fundamentals of communication

Questions

1. How can PR professionals leverage new media to maintain credibility?
2. 4. How can PR professionals promote ethical communication?
2. What strategies can be used to counter fake news in the digital age?
3. What is the biggest challenges facing mass communication today?



THANK YOU

**ANY
QUESTIONS?**